Prime Minister's Performance Delivery Unit (PMDU)
Pakistan Citizen's Portal (PCP)

District Education Authority, Lahore Punjab

PU180426-92524519 (AB)

Print Date: 01/05/2026

A. Complaint Details

DATE OF COMPLAINT	18/04/2026	**CURRENT STATUS**	In Progress (since 13 Days, 0 months, 0 years)
COMPLAINT CATEGORY/ LEVEL 1:	Education	**COMPLAINT SUB-CATEGORY/ LEVEL 2:**	Private Schools (Quality of Education)
LOCATION OF COMPLAINT:	Lahore (Punjab, Pakistan)	**COMPLAINT ADDRESS:**	Gulshan Ravi Lahore
GPS ADDRESS:		**CITIZEN PROFILE**	Provided by Citizen
COMPLAINT SUBJECT	Complaint Against STEP School Gulshan Ravi Branch & Request for Refund		

Contents

I would like to lodge a complaint regarding the unsatisfactory quality of education and teaching methods at STEP School, Gulshan Ravi Branch. I raised these concerns with the school management; however, instead of resolving the issue, they stated that this is their standard teaching method and will continue in the future. I am attaching supporting evidence with this complaint. Due to this response and poor quality of education, we have decided to withdraw our child from the school. I had recently paid Rs. 28,520/- for books and the March fee. I requested a refund, but it has not been processed. Furthermore, selling books within school premises at premium prices is prohibited under the Punjab Private Educational Institutions (Promotion & Regulation) Ordinance, 1984. I respectfully request the concerned authority to direct the school administration to refund my amount so I can secure admission for my child elsewhere.

Attachment

This complaint has **4** attachment.

B. Complaint Processing History

#	DATED	FROM	TO	STATUS	REMARKS
1	29/04/2026	Citizen	District Education Officer (M-EE) Lahore	In-progress	Dear Sir, I understand the refund policy under normal circumstances; however, this matter concerns the quality of education and the teacher's competence. I raised these concerns with the school management and their head office, and they themselves admitted that the fault was on their side and even requested another chance. However, I have been observing these issues since last year and have finally decided to withdraw my child. In such circumstances, it is unfair that I should bear the financial cost of their shortcomings. Regarding the books, they are STEP-specific course material and are of no use to me elsewhere. Moreover, the complete course was not even provided, yet full charges were taken. I possess all relevant proof, including correspondence, fee deposit receipts, and book purchase evidence. Unfortunately, the portal did not allow me to attach these documents. I apologize for the earlier mistyped mobile number; my correct contact number is being provided again. 03338949048
2	29/04/2026	District Education Officer (M-EE) Lahore	Citizen	In-progress	Dear Citizen, We have reviewed your latest response regarding the refund request for tuition fees and books. To move this case toward a formal directive for the school, we require the following specific documentation: Withdrawal Documentation: You stated that the student was withdrawn on 18th March. Please provide a copy of the Formal Withdrawal Application submitted to the school and their SLC (School Leaving Certificate) or acknowledgment of withdrawal. We cannot process a fee refund without proof of the exact date the seat was officially vacated. School Refund Policy: Please share the Terms & Conditions or the Prospectus provided at the time of admission. We need to verify if the school has a documented refund policy for mid-month withdrawals. Proof of Coerced Book Purchase: To establish a violation of the Punjab Private Educational Institutions Ordinance, we need evidence that the school mandated the purchase exclusively from their premises. A "collection message" may be interpreted as a convenience. We require a message or circular stating that books from outside vendors are not allowed or that purchase from the school is compulsory. Correct Contact Details: The phone number provided in your response appears to be incomplete or incorrect. We attempted to contact you for clarification but were unsuccessful. Please provide a functional 11-digit mobile number. Final Notice: Please provide the withdrawal proof and the specific "mandatory purchase" evidence within 48 hours. Without these documents, we cannot legally compel the school to issue a refund, and the complaint will be closed.

#	DATED	FROM	TO	STATUS	REMARKS
3	29/04/2026	District Education Officer (M-EE) Lahore	Citizen	In-progress	Subject: Update Regarding Complaint No. – STEP School Gulshan Ravi Dear Citizen, We have reviewed your latest response regarding the refund request for tuition fees and books. To move this case toward a formal directive for the school, we require the following specific documentation: Withdrawal Documentation: You stated that the student was withdrawn on 18th March. Please provide a copy of the Formal Withdrawal Application submitted to the school and their SLC (School Leaving Certificate) or acknowledgment of withdrawal. We cannot process a fee refund without proof of the exact date the seat was officially vacated. School Refund Policy: Please share the Terms & Conditions or the Prospectus provided at the time of admission. We need to verify if the school has a documented refund policy for mid-month withdrawals. Proof of Coerced Book Purchase: To establish a violation of the Punjab Private Educational Institutions Ordinance, we need evidence that the school mandated the purchase exclusively from their premises. A "collection message" may be interpreted as a convenience. We require a message or circular stating that books from outside vendors are not allowed or that purchase from the school is compulsory. Correct Contact Details: The phone number provided in your response appears to be incomplete or incorrect. We attempted to contact you for clarification but were unsuccessful. Please provide a functional 11-digit mobile number. Final Notice: Please provide the withdrawal proof and the specific "mandatory purchase" evidence within 48 hours. Without these documents, we cannot legally compel the school to issue a refund, and the complaint will be closed.
4	29/04/2026	District Education Officer (M-EE) Lahore	Citizen	In-progress	Subject: Update Regarding Complaint No. [Insert Code] – STEP School Gulshan Ravi Dear Citizen, We have reviewed your latest response regarding the refund request for tuition fees and books. To move this case toward a formal directive for the school, we require the following specific documentation: Withdrawal Documentation: You stated that the student was withdrawn on 18th March. Please provide a copy of the Formal Withdrawal Application submitted to the school and their SLC (School Leaving Certificate) or acknowledgment of withdrawal. We cannot process a fee refund without proof of the exact date the seat was officially vacated. School Refund Policy: Please share the Terms & Conditions or the Prospectus provided at the time of admission. We need to verify if the school has a documented refund policy for mid-month withdrawals. Proof of Coerced Book Purchase: To establish a violation of the Punjab Private Educational Institutions Ordinance, we need evidence that the school mandated the purchase exclusively from their premises. A "collection message" may be interpreted as a convenience. We require a message or circular stating that books from outside vendors are not allowed or that purchase from the school is compulsory. Correct Contact Details: The phone number provided in your response appears to be incomplete or incorrect. We attempted to contact you for clarification but were unsuccessful. Please provide a functional 11-digit mobile number. Final Notice: Please provide the withdrawal proof and the specific "mandatory purchase" evidence within 48 hours. Without these documents, we cannot legally compel the school to issue a refund, and the complaint will be closed.

#	DATED	FROM	TO	STATUS	REMARKS
5	29/04/2026	Citizen	District Education Officer (M-EE) Lahore	In-progress	Dear Sir/Madam, With reference to your email regarding my complaint, I submit the following clarifications: The academic session started on 09 March. However, due to the extremely poor quality of teaching and ineffective online classes, we withdrew our child on 18 March. During this short period, classes were conducted online and the teaching standards were highly unsatisfactory, forcing us to discontinue. Relevant evidence of poor teaching has already been attached with my complaint. Therefore, we request a refund of the March fee. Regarding the books, they are still in my possession in original and unused condition. Parents were informed through the school WhatsApp group to collect books from the school, and the payment was transferred directly to the school account. Proof of transfer and the group message have already been attached. Kindly review the attached evidence and proceed with the refund request. Sincerely, Hasnain Ahmed 0333894048
6	28/04/2026	District Education Officer (M-EE) Lahore	Citizen	In-progress	Dear Applicant,This is with reference to your complaint filed against STEP School, Gulshan Ravi Branch, regarding the quality of education and a refund request amounting to Rs. 28,520/-.To process your grievance, we require the following clarifications and supporting evidence:March Tuition Fee: You have requested a refund for the March fee. Please note that tuition fees cover the period the student was enrolled and the services were rendered. Kindly provide justification as to why you believe the school is liable to refund a fee for a period during which the student held an active seat.Book Purchase & Refund: Regarding the refund for books, please specify if the books are currently in your possession and if they are in their original, unused condition. Generally, items purchased and utilized are non-refundable unless a specific policy or defect is cited.Evidence of Coerced Purchase: You stated that the school forced the purchase of books from their internal store at premium prices. To pursue this as a violation of the Ordinance, we require documentary proof (such as a written circular, SMS, or an official receipt from the school's vendor) specifically mandating that parents purchase exclusively from the school premises.Notice of Action: Please provide the requested information and evidence within 48 hours of receiving this email. Failure to provide these details will result in the automatic closure of your complaint due to insufficient evidence.We look forward to your prompt response to move this matter forward.Regards,
7	21/04/2026	CEO DEA, Lahore	District Education Officer (M-EE) Lahore	In-progress	Respected Officer! kindly look into the matter and resolve it under rules / policy/Thanks
8	20/04/2026	Secretary, School Education	CEO DEA, Lahore	In-progress	Respected Officer! kindly look into the matter and resolve it under rules / policy/Thanks
9	18/04/2026	Initiated	Secretary, School Education	In-progress	Complaint has been assigned to Secretary, School Education